

Wilhelmina Corvane

Character Dossier

Cautious, precise and haunted playwright of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon

Overview

Wilhelmina Corvane is a playwright living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Wilhelmina is 25 years old, originally from Little Ashby, and is known around the Reading Well as cautious, precise and haunted. In conversation Wilhelmina counts things aloud when nervous.

Background

Wilhelmina arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 2 years ago after leaving Little Ashby under circumstances Wilhelmina describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Wilhelmina works as a playwright near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Wilhelmina learned the trade from Petra Nightingale, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Wilhelmina's life is with Jorah Zimmerling, over a matter neither will explain. The person Wilhelmina trusts most is Lysander Nightingale.

Current goal: to keep Lysander Nightingale out of trouble for one full season. Greatest fear: crowds that go quiet all at once.

Personality and speech

Temperament: cautious, precise and haunted.

Speech pattern: Wilhelmina counts things aloud when nervous.

Tells: when lying, Wilhelmina mentions Velvet the hawk for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Wilhelmina Corvane
Role	playwright
Home	the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon
Hometown	Little Ashby
Age	25
Favourite dish	twice-cooked fried plantains
Pet	Velvet, a hawk

<i>Lucky number</i>	777
<i>Workshop password</i>	oak-pepper
<i>Mentor</i>	Petra Nightingale
<i>Rival</i>	Jorah Zimmerling
<i>Closest friend</i>	Lysander Nightingale

Secret

Wilhelmina once forged a letter of passage for a stranger who turned out to be a wanted person, and still keeps the copy.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Wilhelmina: I am the playwright. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Wilhelmina: Twice-cooked fried plantains. Do not tell Jorah I said so.

Visitor: Is Velvet yours?

Wilhelmina: Velvet belongs to nobody. Velvet tolerates me. Lucky number is 777, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, autumn of year 9

Ingrid came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wilhelmina repaired the brass lantern at the Reading Well for Zeph, who paid in 13 ink-weights and a long story about the tax on doors. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the wax seal indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the quarantine. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance.

Entry 2, autumn of year 9

Rumours about the quarantine reached the Archivist's cell. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Someone left a glass float on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right.

Entry 3, winter of year 9

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the ledger indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the old tunnels. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the rumour of a second well. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the right way to mend a net for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 4, autumn of year 9

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the copper pipe indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the tax on doors. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right.

Entry 5, winter of year 10

Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 63 of everything, except the wax seal, which is always short. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 33 of everything, except the tin whistle, which is always short. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the old tunnels. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 6, spring of year 10

Someone left a pair of spectacles on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. Wilhelmina repaired the clockwork bird at the cataloguers' gallery for Jasper, who paid in 36 ink-weights and a long story about the harvest count. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the cataloguers' gallery, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 7, autumn of year 10

Seraphine came by asking about the new curfew. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a brass lantern on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. Someone left a ledger on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right.

Entry 8, spring of year 10

A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the cataloguers' gallery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over who really won the regatta flared up between Wilhelmina and Jorah outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 86 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 9, summer of year 10

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wilhelmina won 76 ink-weights from Jorah on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on twice-cooked fried plantains. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 87 of everything, except the brass lantern, which is always short. Someone left a bundle of letters on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right.

Entry 10, spring of year 10

Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance. Wilhelmina won 13 ink-weights from Jorah on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on twice-cooked fried plantains. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the sluice gates, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a bolt of linen from the Reading Well to the sluice gates without opening it, and mostly succeeded. At the Reading Well, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real wax seal from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 11, winter of year 10

Wilhelmina won 71 ink-weights from Jorah on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on twice-cooked fried plantains. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Wilhelmina and Jorah outside the sluice gates; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a sextant from the sluice gates to the Archivist's cell without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached the sluice gates. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 12, autumn of year 10

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the right way to mend a net. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Oduya came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Someone left a grain scale on the doorstep

with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a sextant from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 13, summer of year 11

Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the old tunnels flared up between Wilhelmina and Jorah outside the Stacks of Ash; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a copper pipe from the Stacks of Ash to the cataloguers' gallery without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 14, winter of year 11

the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Wilhelmina found a coil of rope half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 90 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 15, summer of year 11

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Wilhelmina and Jorah outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the brass lantern indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the price of lamp oil.

Entry 16, summer of year 11

Someone left a iron kettle on the doorstep with no note. Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the glass float indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina repaired the ledger at the Reading Well for Cassius, who paid in 40 ink-weights and a long story about the rumour of a second well. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the missing shipment. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 17, spring of year 12

A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the cataloguers' gallery, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Stacks of Ash: 59 of everything, except the grain scale, which is always short.

Entry 18, autumn of year 12

Wilhelmina won 73 ink-weights from Jorah on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on twice-cooked fried plantains. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note.

Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. Rumours about the census reached the cataloguers' gallery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Wilhelmina found a coil of rope half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 19, summer of year 12

Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the Archivist's cell: 71 of everything, except the bolt of linen, which is always short. At the Archivist's cell, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone. Wilhelmina repaired the wax seal at the Archivist's cell for Ingrid, who paid in 3 ink-weights and a long story about the new curfew.

Entry 20, spring of year 12

At the sluice gates, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Someone left a bolt of linen on the doorstep with no note.

Wilhelmina suspects Lysander and is probably right. Wilhelmina was hired to carry a tin whistle from the sluice gates to the Archivist's cell without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 21, summer of year 13

Wilhelmina found a brass lantern half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. A dispute over the comet flared up between Wilhelmina and Jorah outside the cataloguers' gallery; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Wilhelmina found a hand bell half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Rumours about whether the bridge will hold reached the cataloguers' gallery. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Wilhelmina found a spool of wire half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 22, winter of year 13

Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Stacks of Ash. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Rumours about the tariff on salt reached the Stacks of Ash. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the cracked compass indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the tax on doors. Rumours about the comet reached the Stacks of Ash. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 23, summer of year 13

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the spool of wire indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the right way to mend a net. At the sluice gates, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Rumours about the

rumour of a second well reached the sluice gates. Wilhelmina pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 24, spring of year 13

Wilhelmina found a pair of spectacles half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the census. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 25, spring of year 13

At the Reading Well, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. At the Reading Well, Wilhelmina taught Lysander how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the glass float indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the comet. Hollis came by asking about the singing at the docks. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 26, summer of year 13

The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the signal flag indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the tariff on salt. Phaedra came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Wilhelmina said nothing useful and made tea instead. Wilhelmina closed early, walked to the Reading Well, and watched the lights come on. Velvet followed at a distance. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Wilhelmina read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 27, autumn of year 13

Wilhelmina found a oilskin map half-buried near the cataloguers' gallery and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the hand bell indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the census. The weather turned. Wilhelmina moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Velvet, and wrote three lines to Petra about the missing shipment.

Entry 28, summer of year 13

Wilhelmina repaired the oilskin map at the cataloguers' gallery for Yusuf, who paid in 33 ink-weights and a long story about the new curfew. Wilhelmina won 49 ink-weights from Jorah on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on twice-cooked fried plantains. A stranger asked Wilhelmina for the password to the workshop. Wilhelmina laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Wilhelmina spent the day counting stock at the cataloguers' gallery: 5 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Petra visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before.